File permissions in Linux

Project description

In this section, I learned that as a cybersecurity analyst it is essential to maintain and manage the correct permissions for each department. This includes monitoring the environment and ensuring that users have only the access they need. I also learned how to modify permissions by adding, changing, or revoking access when necessary. In addition, I gained experience interpreting Linux permission strings and using the `chmod` command to control access for users, groups, and others. Proper permission management helps protect files and systems by ensuring that only authorized users have the appropriate level of access.

Check file and directory details

First thing to keep in mind as we checking is the command that help us to see if something is wrong, with the command `ls -l or ls -la` option to display a detailed listing of the file contents that also returned hidden files. The output of my command indicates that there is one directory named `drafts`, one hidden file named `.project_x.txt`, and five other project files. The 10-character string in the first column represents the permissions set on each file or directory.

```
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 ..
-rw--w---- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 .project_x.txt
drwx--x--- 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 drafts
-rw-rw-rw- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_t.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$
```

Describe the permissions string

As we look a it, the first one `.project_k.txt`
`-rw-rw-r-- project_r.txt` The permissions string consists of ten characters. The first character indicates the file type (`-` for a file and `d` for a directory). The remaining nine characters are divided into three groups representing the permissions for the owner, group, and others. The letters
`r -> read`
`w -> write`
`and x -> execute permissions,`
while `-` indicates that a permission is not granted.

Change file permissions

As we know the Zero trust procedure now we can execute the right command to change the permission of the file I used the chmod command to modify file permissions. I removed unnecessary permissions from users who should not have access to the file, following the principle of least privilege.

```
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ chmod o-w project_k.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 ..
-rw--w---- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 .project_x.txt
drwx--x--- 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 drafts
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_t.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$
```

Change file permissions on a hidden file

I modified the permissions of the hidden file `.project_x.txt` using the `chmod` command. I know `.project_x.txt` is a hidden file because it starts with a period (`.`). In this example, I removed write permissions from the user and group, and added read permissions to the group. I removed write permissions from the user with `u-w`. Then, I removed write permissions from the group with `g-w`, and added read permissions to the group with `g+r`.

```
researcher2@3213bbc1d047:~/projects$ chmod u-w,g-w,g+r .project_x.txt
researcher2@3213bbc1d047:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec 20 15:36 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec 20 15:36 ..
-r--r----- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec 20 15:36 .project_x.txt
drwx--x--- 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec 20 15:36 drafts
-rw-rw-rw- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec 20 15:36 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec 20 15:36 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec 20 15:36 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec 20 15:36 project_t.txt
researcher2@3213bbc1d047:~/projects$
```

Change directory permissions

I changed the permissions of the drafts directory to restrict access according to the project's security requirements. Adjusting directory permissions helps protect the files stored inside by limiting who can enter or modify the directory.
Here you can see that only researcher2 has execute permissions. It was previously determined that the group had execute permissions, so I used the `chmod` command to remove them. The `researcher2` user already had execute permissions, so they did not need to be added.

```
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ chmod g-x drafts
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 ..
-r--r----- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 .project_x.txt
drwx------ 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 drafts
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team   46 Dec  2 15:27 project_t.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$
```

Summary

This project improved my understanding of Linux file permissions and how they protect system resources. I learned to interpret permission strings, view file details using `ls -la`, and modify permissions with `chmod` to ensure that users have only the access they need.